



Amoeba can blind you

Dirty Contact lenses and bad hygiene are helping spread an amoeba that can blind contact lens wearers. <https://digit.in/oct18-78-1>



Puppies spread Diarrhea

Puppie poop gave 118 people diarrhea in a recent outbreak caused by the antibiotic-resistant bacteria. <https://digit.in/oct18-78-2>



Blockchain in Healthcare

How this cutting edge technology can redefine healthcare for the futures

Arnab Mukherjee | arnab@digit.in

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technology and healthcare are inseparable in today's day and age. There are numerous examples

of scientific advancements improving the state of healthcare through robotics, genetics and even artificial intelligence. However, one of the most crucial areas where healthcare suffers is in data. The data that the healthcare industry deals with involves information extremely personal to individuals. A typical patient file could contain information about the patients physical attributes, their previous ailments, their known allergies, their financial records, their insurance, their dependants and more.

However, it is often not treated any different from, say, how a fast food restaurant would treat their customer records. To change that, the healthcare industry is turning to distributed ledger technology, or how it is more commonly (and perhaps, wrongly) known as, the blockchain.

A pretty basic way in which blockchain could help healthcare anywhere in the world is through universal, tamper-proof records. Patient records on the blockchain could be accessed everywhere without the fear of them being tampered with. Blockchain would allow only authorized nodes with access to the ledger to make changes, and those changes would immediately be verified against other instances of the ledger. This would also protect them from data theft. Also, every change made would be traceable. So in case any doctor or medical practitioner needs to know more about any information present in a patient record, they'd know exactly whom to ask. This also takes care of the possibility of insurance fraud. If every record can be traced to its source, then

there wouldn't be a way for insurance brokers or patients to produce fake records to file fraudulent claims.

One of the biggest problems facing the medical industry pertains to the pharmaceuticals. Medicines and drugs manufactured by certain companies are often counterfeited. According to some statistics, counterfeit drugs cost the United States \$200 billion and 750,000 jobs. Blockchain would allow medical companies to track their products, especially controlled substances, from the point of manufacture to the pharmaceutical store, effectively reducing the possibilities of theft and counterfeit.

Medical research and experimentation would also benefit a lot from blockchain technology. Clinical trials conducted in one part of the world could be accessible everywhere and could be used as a base for drug approvals in other countries without the need to conduct trials all over again. In these same trials, the consent taken from the patients could use smart contracts that can also be accessible everywhere.

On top of that, ICOs could be used to finance new R&D initiatives where investors, big and small, could invest finances into the healthcare industry with a prospect that is backed by smart contracts and mortgages. Pretty soon we might see similar implementations showing up in India, especially from the government. 